

María Hernández-de-Benito

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Current Position

CUNEF Universidad, Madrid, Spain 2025–Present
Assistant Professor of Economics (tenure track)

Previous Positions

University of Alicante Fall 2021–2024
Assistant Professor of Economics

Aix-Marseille School of Economics Summer 2023
Visiting Researcher

CEMFI Fall 2022
Visiting Researcher

Other Appointments

JPAL Invited Researcher Fall 2023–Present
Member, Spanish Policy Lab for Social Inclusion Spring 2022–Present
Member, Measures for Advancing Gender Equality (MAGNET) Initiative Spring 2021–Present

Research Fields

Applied Microeconomics; Development Economics; Household and Gender Economics; Labor.

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Georgetown University, Washington DC 2015–2021
Dissertation: Essays on gender and development economics
Committee: Garance Genicot, Martin Ravallion, Andrew Zeitlin

MA in Economics, New York University, NY 2011–2013

BS in Economics, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Spain 2007–2011

Publications

- Persistent yet ameliorable shocks to female entrepreneurship: Experimental evidence from Kenya (with Francisco Campos, Julian Hamison, Abba Safir and Bilal Zia), 2025. *Journal of Development Economics*.
- Women's land rights and village institutions in Tanzania (with Garance Genicot), 2022. *World Development*.

Working Papers

- Firstborn Daughters and Family Structure in Sub-Saharan Africa (with Garance Genicot).
- This is a Man's World: Crime and Intra-Household Resource Allocation.
- Measuring Agency Through Psychological Constructs in Lower-Income Settings (with Clare Clin- gain and Aletheia Donald)
- Personalized Social Services and Socioeconomic Inclusion: Experimental Evidence from Spain (with María Calle García and Teresa Molina-Millán)

Selected Work in Progress

- Online tutoring at scale (with Lucas Gortazar, Claudia Hupkau, Teresa Molina-Millán, and Antonio Roldan-Mones)
- Unaccompanied migrant youth: design and complementarities between labor, mental health, and community interventions (with Teresa Molina-Millán)
- Boosting Youth Entrepreneurship with Grants, Human Capital Support, and Behavioral Insights (with Yanina Domenella, Julian Jamison, Abba Safir, and Bilal Zia)
- The Effects of Boosting Youth Entrepreneurship on Marital Outcomes and Intimate Partner Violence (with Yanina Domenella, Julian Jamison, and Abba Safir)

Honors, Fellowships, and Research Grants

European Social Inclusion Initiative Pilot Grant, JPAL	2026–2027
Crime and Violence Initiative Exploratory Grant, JPAL	2025–2026
Displaced Livelihoods Initiative Exploratory Grant, JPAL	2024–2025
Juan de la Cierva Fellowship, Spain Ministry of Science and Innovation	2022–2024
IPA's Intimate Partner Violence Competitive Fund	2022
IPA's Women's Work, Entrepreneurship, and Skilling (WWES)	2022
Razin Prize, Georgetown University Economics Department	2021
Premio Nada es Gratis to Job Market Papers in Economics	2020
Maloof Fellowship, Georgetown University	2020–2021
Doctoral Candidate Fellowship, Center for Global Development	Summer 2019
PhD Fellowship, Georgetown University	2015–2020
Award for Excellence in Microeconomics, NYU	Spring 2012
Graduate Studies Scholarship, Bank of Spain	2011–2013
Research Assistant Scholarship, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2010–2011

Research Experience and Other Employment

Short-Term Consultant, Gender Innovation Lab, World Bank	2021
Senior Research Associate, Innovations for Poverty Action	2020–2021
Research Assistant, Prof. Garance Genicot, Georgetown University	2017–2019
Fieldwork in Tanzania, Georgetown University	2017–2018
Analyst, NERA Economic Consulting, New York	2013–2015

Economics Intern, Roubini Global Economics, New York	2012–2013
Summer Analyst, Market Risk, Goldman Sachs, New York	2012
Research Assistant, Universidad Carlos III Madrid	2010–2011
Microfinance Internship, Hindusthan Microfinance LTD, Mumbai	2010

Conference Presentations and Invited Seminars

2025: XIV COSME Gender Economics Workshop; Society of Economics of the Household Meeting (SEHO); 4th Economics and Gender Workshop, University of Luxembourg; European Economic Association Conference (EEA).

2024: CUNEF seminar; North East Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC) conference; II Spanish Workshop in Development Economics; Behavioural Public Policy Conference, University of Cambridge; Georgian Economic Association Conference.

2023: American University seminar; German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA) seminar; The Economics of Social Norms Workshop, Université Paris Dauphine; Spanish Economic Association Symposium (SAEe); Congreso de la Red Española de Política Social (REPS); I Spanish Workshop in Development Economics; REACH International Conference, Oxford University; Nordic Conference in Development Economics (NCDE).

2022: Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) seminar; Spanish Economic Association Symposium (SAEe); NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development; European Society for Population Economics Conference (ESPE); Center for the study of African economies Conference (CSAE); American Economic Association Annual Meeting (ASSA).

2021: University of Exeter seminar; Pontificia Universidad Javeriana seminar; Navarra Center for International Development seminar; Université de Montréal seminar; Universidad de Alicante seminar; University of Surrey seminar; Abt Associates seminar; Universidad del Rosario seminar; University of Vienna seminar; CUNEF Universidad; North East Universities Development Consortium conference (NEUDC); European Association of Labour Economists Conference (EALE); International Conference on Globalization and Development (GlaD); Midwest International Economic Development Conference; International Association for Feminist Economics Conference (IAFFE).

2020: Spanish Economic Association Symposium (SAEe); Ridge Political Economy of Conflict and Crime workshop; Southern Economic Association; Economics PhD Conference, University of Warwick; Bolivian Conference on Development Economics; IPWSD, Columbia University.

2019: Center for Global Development seminar; WZB Berlin Social Center, IPI Brownbag seminar; Mortara International Georgetown University seminar; Southern Economic Association; Sustainability and Development Conference, University of Michigan; SEBOL Development Studies Workshop; GCER conference, Georgetown University.

Teaching Experience

Policy Evaluation, Instructor, CUNEF Universidad	Spring 2025,2026
Microeconomics, Instructor, CUNEF Universidad	Spring 2025,2026
Econometrics II (MA), Instructor, University of Alicante	Spring 2023, 2024
Development Economics, Instructor, University of Alicante	Spring 2022

Economic Statistics, Instructor, Georgetown University	Summer 2020
Economic Statistics, TA, Georgetown University	Spring 2019, 2020
Econometrics (MA), TA, Georgetown University	Fall 2019
Data Analysis (MA), TA, Georgetown University	Fall 2018
Development Economics, TA, Georgetown University	Spring 2018
Intro to Econometrics, TA, Georgetown University	Fall 2017
PhD 1st Year Official Tutor, Georgetown University	2016–2017

Professional Services

External Reviewer for Ministerio de Ciencia, Innovación y Universidades.

Co-organizer of the III Spanish Workshop in Development Economics.

Journal Referee Activities

The Quarterly Journal of Economics; Journal of the European Economic Association (JEEA); Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Human Resources; Quantitative Economics; EDCC; Demography; Journal of Demographic Economics; Journal of Population Economics; Labour; Labour Economics; PLOS ONE; Oxford Development Studies.

Other Information

STATA, R, SAS, L^AT_EX, GIS, Survey Solutions, MS Office.

Languages: Spanish (native); English (advanced); French (intermediate)